JUAN PASCUAL

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University of Barcelona, John M. Keynes 1-11, (08034)

Education

University of Barcelona 2024 - 2028 (expected)
PhD Candidate in Economics
Thesis committee: Jennifer Ruiz-Valenzuela & Daniel Montolio

Barcelona School of Economics 2021
MSc in Economics

University of Valencia 2016 - 2020
BSc in Economics – Summa Cum Laude (Top 1%)
Exchange: University of Bristol (UK) and Universidad Autónoma de Madrid (Spain)

Affiliations

Opportunity Insights, Harvard University 2026 - June 2027
Visiting Researcher; Host: Professor Raj Chetty

Barcelona Institute of Economics (IEB) 2024 -
Affiliated Researcher

Laboratorio de Oportunidades (Spanish Opportunity Lab) 2025 -
Affiliated Researcher

Future Policy Lab 2024 -
Research Fellow

Fields of Interest

Primary: Economics of Education
Secondary: Intergenerational Mobility, Economics of Crime

Work in Progress

Apprenticeships and Crime: Evidence from Spain's Vocational Training Reform (with Montolio, D. & Ruiz-Valenzuela, J.)

We examine the impact of dual vocational training (DVT) on youth crime rates in Catalonia. DVT expands on-the-job training in firms relative to regular school-based vocational training. We exploit its staggered geographical rollout using a difference-in-differences approach and detailed administrative education records linked to geolocated crime data. We find that greater availability of firm-based vocational training significantly reduces local youth crime rates. Reductions concentrate during daytime hours, consistent with incapacitation. Declines are strongest for economically motivated property crimes, consistent with increased opportunity costs through improved labor-market prospects. These results suggest that apprenticeship-style programs can deliver substantial non-pecuniary social returns.

School Segregation, Educational Achievement and Sorting: Evidence from Barcelona's Shock Plan (with Oberhuemer C. & Quintana S.)

Barcelona's Shock Plan Against School Segregation reserves seats for socioeconomically vulnerable students in each public and charter school. We estimate impacts on school segregation, parental applications, and achievement using difference-in-differences and a structural model of school and neighborhood choice. Preliminary results show sizable reductions in segregation as schools converge to quota targets. However, higher vulnerable student shares lead to fewer applications from non-vulnerable families.

Presentations

2026 CESifo Junior Workshop on the Economics of Education;
15th European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association;
5th Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars

2025 19th North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (UEA);
Second Freiburg PhD-Workshop on the Economics of Criminal Behavior

2024 UB PhD Applied Student Seminar; BSE Jamboree; UB Internal Applied Seminar

References

Jennifer Ruiz-Valenzuela
Associate Professor at Universitat de Barcelona
jruizv@ub.edu

Daniel Montolio
Full Professor at Universitat de Barcelona
montolio@ub.edu

Santiago Reyes
Economist at The World Bank
sreyesortega@ifc.org

Research Experience

The World Bank 2023 - 2025
Field Coordinator

International Initiative for Impact Evaluation (3ie) 2023 - 2024
Research Consultant

Knowledge Sharing Network (KSNET) 2022 - 2023
Research Economist

University of Zurich 2021 - 2022
Pre-Doctoral Fellow
Supervisors: Bruno Caprettini & Hans-Joachim Voth

University of Valencia 2020
Research Assistant
Supervisor: Luis Miguel Granero

University of Bristol 2019
Research Assistant
Supervisor: Gianluca Veronesi

Teaching

Universitat de Barcelona 2024 - 2025
Teaching Assistant – Spanish Economy (undergraduate)

Academic Service

Referee for Journal of Policy Evaluation

Grants and Honours

FPU Scholarship – Spanish Ministry of Universities	2024 -
Extraordinary Degree Award – University of Valencia	2020
Undergraduate Scholarship – Spanish Ministry of Education	2016
Honors Distinction – High School Graduation	2016

Miscellaneous

Citizenship	Spanish
Languages	Spanish (native), Catalan (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)
Software	Stata, Python, R, ArcGIS, LaTeX

Updated November 2026